Sangavi R

md25mdes14023@iith.ac.in | postbox.sang@gmail.com | +91 9080560242 | LinkedIn | GitHub

EDUCATION

Institution	Degree / Board	Passing Year	Score / CGPA
Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad	B.Tech	2027	8.22
SKNS PMC Vivekananda Vidhyalaya Junior College	Class XII (CBSE)	2016	57.60%
Railway Mixed Higher Secondary School	Class X (Tamil Nadu state board)	2014	86.30%

SUMMARY

I work as a UX and Interaction Designer with a background in Architecture, focused on making systems clear, usable, and grounded in real-world context. I'm drawn to problems where things feel complex or unclear, and I work through research and structure to make them easier to understand and use. Currently pursuing M.Des in Interaction Design at IIT Hyderabad.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Summer Design Intern | Jamoons Digitals | 06/2026 - 08/2026

NETS Singapore | Unified Digital Wallet Experience

- Ecosystem Audit & Information Architecture: Audited Singapore's NETS payment ecosystem to identify friction across multiple physical cards and reframe the experience from a card-centric to a wallet-centric architecture.
- Unified Wallet: Designed end-to-end UI and wireframe workflows for a consolidated digital wallet integrating Singpass verification, automated top-up triggers and shared sub-accounts for family spending.
- Safety & Risk Mitigation: Designed ring-fenced Main, Personal and Linked Wallet spaces to protect primary bank balances while reducing physical card dependency and manual top-up steps.
- System Design: Explored how a fragmented card ecosystem could transition into a scalable wallet-based information architecture and interaction model.

Interaction Designer | KappaX.io | 08/2024 - 07/2025

- Revenue & Growth: Designed interactive advertising interfaces using the Kappa framework, contributing to a 15% increase in platform revenue by making user actions clearer and easier to complete.
- Product Redesign: Redesigned the core information architecture and interaction flow for the platform's v3 website, using usability audits to identify and resolve navigation and discoverability issues.
- Design Systems: Developed reusable UI components and advertising templates across product categories, improving consistency across product experiences and supporting faster design-development workflows.
- Interaction Design: Translated business requirements into clearer interaction patterns and interface structures across the platform.

Associate UX Designer | Lollypop Design Studio | 08/2023 - 02/2024

Let'sbuild.healthcare

- Led UX design for an end-to-end healthcare platform.
- Facilitated stakeholder discovery workshops to understand complex healthcare processes and user needs.
- Translated complex medical tasks into structured digital workflows and user journeys.

HDFC ERGO Career Portal

- Designed interface modules for candidate tracking, role matching and recruiter dashboards.
- Developed structured design handoffs to support implementation by development teams.

Design Community

- Founded PopShare, an internal weekly knowledge-sharing initiative focused on research methods, interaction patterns and design practices.
- Created a platform for designers to
- share methods, learnings and emerging design approaches.

UI/UX Designer | Unicorn Design Studio | 12/2022 - 07/2023

- Website Design: Designed the studio's marketing website from the ground up, defining information architecture, visual direction, core screens and reusable UI components.
- UX Audits: Conducted 60+ heuristic UX audits for client presentations and business pitches, identifying usability issues and opportunities for product improvement.
- Business Development: Applied UX evaluation and design thinking to client pitches, contributing to new business opportunities and project acquisition.
- Design Advocacy: Represented the studio in client discussions, design conversations and podcasts, communicating UX principles and design decisions to external audiences.

UI/UX Design Intern | Designient School of Design | 10/2022 - 12/2022

- E-commerce UX: Contributed to a Decathlon website redesign by analysing competitor experiences and identifying usability issues and checkout friction.
- Visual Design: Created digital visual assets and social media graphics aligned with established brand guidelines.
- UX Practice: Applied user-centred design, competitive analysis and interface design principles to real-world redesign exercises.

POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

Head of Design - E-Cell, IIT Hyderabad *(2025 - Present)*

- Lead design initiatives and contribute to the visual and communication direction of the entrepreneurship ecosystem.
- Support event, communication and design requirements across E-Cell activities.
- Collaborate with multidisciplinary student teams to translate ideas into clear visual and communication outputs.

Head of Events - India HCI Conference, IIT Hyderabad *(2026 tunure)*

- Contribute to planning and execution of the India HCI conference.
- Work around the theme "Design for Dignity", focusing on inclusive, accessible and responsible design.
- Contribute to positioning the conference around Indian and Hyderabad design communities.

Core Member - Behind the Lens, IIT Hyderabad *(2026 tenure)*

- Core member of the institute's film-making and visual storytelling club.
- Participate in collaborative film-making and visual media activities.

Coordinator - RDM Member, IIT Hyderabad *(2025 - Present)*

- Theatrical performer with experience in mime and stage performance.
- Won 4th position in Inter IIT Culturals 8.0 - IIT Kanpur

Branch representative - Popshare, Lollypop Design Studio *(2023-2024)*

- Conducted weekly popshare sessions.
- Organised and hosted the events for employee socio-cultural interactions.

PROJECTS

NETS Digital Cards: Tap-to-Pay NFC Experience

Interaction Design | UX Research | Haptic Interaction

- Investigated moments of uncertainty in contactless payments, examining how users interpret physical, visual, and haptic feedback during NFC transactions.
- Conducted usability testing with 20+ users across mobile devices to identify gaps between transaction completion and users' perception of payment confirmation.
- Designed micro-interactions and haptic feedback patterns that communicate transaction states immediately, strengthening feedback clarity and user confidence at the point of payment.

CoverMitra: Interactive Insurance Ad Experience

Interaction Design | Information Design

- *Investigated information overload and decision friction in static insurance advertising, identifying opportunities to make complex plan information easier to explore and compare.*
- *Transformed a passive advertisement into an eight-stage guided Q&A experience using progressive disclosure, contextual prompts, and focused decision points.*
- *Designed an interactive communication model that surfaces relevant information progressively, reducing cognitive load while creating a more engaging path from awareness to plan exploration.*

Making Payroll Work for People

Enterprise UX | *Information Architecture* | *Interaction Design*

- Investigated how employees navigate fragmented payroll information across payslips, deductions, benefits, reimbursements, and salary changes to identify gaps in understanding and self-service.
- Reframed payroll around employee intent, connecting questions with contextual explanations, supporting evidence, comparisons, and actionable next steps.
- Designed an interaction model that moves users from understanding to verification and resolution, balancing automation with transparency, control, and human escalation.

When Prompts Aren't Enough

Conversational UX | *HCI* | *Interaction Design*

- Investigated the gap between what users communicate and what conversational systems interpret, focusing on ambiguity, implicit goals, changing intent, and contextual dependencies.
- Mapped conversational breakdowns across incomplete requests, corrections, follow-up questions, and multi-step tasks to identify opportunities beyond conventional prompt-response interactions.
- Developed interaction patterns for intent clarification, contextual response, confirmation, and recovery, creating a more transparent and controllable conversational experience.

Who Are You, When You Vote?

Speculative Design | *Editorial Design* | *Political Communication*

- Explored how political messaging, social influence, identity, and cognitive biases shape the way young people interpret political information and make voting decisions.
- Designed an interactive editorial publication combining political satire, illustration, tactile interaction, and visual storytelling to turn passive reading into active reflection.
- Created a sequence of participatory interactions that encourage readers to pause, question persuasive narratives, and examine the assumptions influencing their own choices.

ONGOING RESEARCH

Specialization Project - Conversational AI, Dept of Design, IIT Hyderabad | 2026

Part 1: Understanding Intent Communication in Conversational AI

Research

Investigating how people communicate intent through conversational interfaces and how AI systems interpret intent across language, context, ambiguity and user expectations.

Focus Areas

- User intent and intent expression
- Ambiguity and underspecified requests
- Context and conversational continuity
- User expectations versus AI interpretation
- Intent mismatch and communication breakdowns
- Mental models of conversational AI
- Trust, transparency and perceived understanding

Part 2: Designing Intent-Aware Interaction for Conversational AI

Interaction Design

Translating research insights into interaction patterns that make intent communication clearer and enable conversational AI to better understand, clarify and respond to users.

Focus Areas

- Intent-aware interaction patterns
- Clarification and disambiguation

- Communicating assumptions
- User-AI feedback loops
- Context-aware interaction
- Error recovery
- Transparency and explainability
- Designing for uncertainty in conversational systems

Research Direction: Human-Centered AI · Conversational UX · Intent Communication · Interaction Design · AI-Assisted Interaction

RESEARCH METHODS

User Interviews · Stakeholder Interviews · Contextual Inquiry · User Observation · Surveys · Competitive Analysis · Comparative Analysis · Heuristic Evaluation · Usability Testing · User Journey Mapping · Persona Development · User Flows · Information Architecture · Affinity Mapping · Thematic Analysis · Literature Review · Desk Research · Secondary Research · Ecosystem Mapping · Card Sorting · Design Workshops

TOOLS

UI/UX & Prototyping

Figma · FigJam · Adobe XD · Sketch · Framer

Visual & Graphic Design

Adobe Photoshop · Illustrator · InDesign · After Effects · Premiere Pro

Research & Collaboration

Miro · Notion · Google Workspace · Microsoft Office

AI & Emerging Tools

ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini · Microsoft Copilot

SKILLS

UX & Design Research

Contextual Interviews, User Observation, Ethnographic Research, Competitor Analysis, Journey Mapping, Usability Testing, User Testing, Research Synthesis

Interaction & Product Design

Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Systems Thinking, User Flows, Wireframing, Low- & High-Fidelity Prototyping, Design Systems, Haptic Interaction

Design Strategy

Problem Framing, Stakeholder Mapping, Value Proposition Mapping, Workshop Facilitation, Ideation, Design Storytelling

Collaboration

Cross-Functional Collaboration, Developer Handoffs, Presentation, Mentoring, Stakeholder Communication, Business pitching

RELEVANT COURSES

Google UX Design Professional Certificate - Coursera

UI/UX Pro Course - Designient School of Design, 3-month program

Adobe UX Design Certification - 83%

M.Des Interaction Design coursework - IIT Hyderabad: User Experience Design, Interaction Design, Design Research, Data & Infographics, etc.

EXTRACURRICULAR

Bharatanatyam Dancer & Instructor

20+ years of learning and teaching

- Learning and performing Bharatanatyam for more than two decades.
- Teaching Bharatanatyam since 2018, also teaching in IIT Hyderabad.
- Founded and runs a Bharatanatyam dance school since 2024, training approximately 20 students.
- Recipient of the Natya Mayuri Award from the Fine Art Society of Tamil Nadu.
- Disciple of Smt. Kavya Muralidharan.
- Completed Grade 6 Bharatanatyam examination.

Bharat scouts and guides

20+ years of experience

- Won in 15+ District and State Rallies.
- Represented Southern Railway in International Railway Jambooree.
- Founding member of an NGO.
- 300+ social awareness campaigns and programs
- Training and teaching young cubs and bulbuls
- Camping, first aid etc.

Indian Army

Conference out - SSB | SSCW Tech 25

SCHOLASTIC ACHIEVEMENTS

Best Architecture Thesis Award - B.Arch., Anna University, recognized by NASA for excellence in undergraduate architectural thesis work.

Jagriti Yatra 2019 - Fellow & Fully Funded Participant, selected to participate in the national experiential learning journey focused on entrepreneurship, social innovation, and nation-building.

Indian Army SSB - SSCW Technical 35 Entry: Progressed to the **Conference Stage** of the Services Selection Board selection process for the Indian Army.